

WEBSITE ANALYSIS & REDESIGN RECOMMENDATIONS

The Shepherd & Me · www.shepherdandme.com

Prepared by Spark Alliance · July 8, 2026

1. Executive Summary

This report is based on a full manual review of shepherdandme.com conducted on July 8, 2026: every one of the site's twelve public pages was clicked through on both desktop (1440px) and mobile (390px) viewports, and we inspected the site's source metadata, browser console, network behavior, imagery, and copy. The site is built on Wix.

First, what deserves to be said plainly: the substance of this website is strong. Andrew and Maria's personal testimonies are moving and courageous, the twelve client testimonials are detailed and credible, the mission and vision are clearly articulated, programs are described with transparent pricing and inclusions, and the site carries a complete set of legal pages — something many small ministries never get around to. The raw material here is better than what most established coaching practices have.

The problem is that the current presentation actively works against that material. Our review found roughly forty distinct issues, five of which we consider critical:

- **The entire site is hidden from search engines.** Every page carries a "noindex" directive — Google is explicitly told not to list the site. Nobody searching for Christian life coaching, spiritual coaching, or even "The Shepherd and Me" by name can find it.
- **An internal project name is shown to the public.** Every browser tab, bookmark, and social share displays "New SAM 2026" instead of the ministry's name.
- **Key conversion paths are broken or circular.** The homepage Donate button leads to the contact page; the coaching page's "Book a Discovery Call" links back to the very page the visitor is already on; there is no scheduling mechanism anywhere.
- **Animation settings leave selling copy nearly invisible.** Program descriptions and prices render in pale gray on a pale background and in places remain half-faded; a major heading ("Coaching Programs") renders partly off-screen.
- **Template leftovers and typos undermine trust.** Gardening stock photos on the coaching page, footer social icons that link to Wix's own accounts, another organization's name ("Harvest Ministries") left inside the Terms of Use, the ministry's own domain misspelled two different ways in its legal pages, and visible typos such as "Minsitry Disclaimer" and "Reund Policy."

The encouraging news: nearly every critical item can be fixed inside Wix within about a week at no cost. Alongside this report we have prepared a working redesign demo (a single HTML file) that rebuilds all main pages using the ministry's existing brand, imagery, and copy — showing how the same content can be presented with modern hierarchy, consistent navigation, a single clear call-to-action system, and accessibility-compliant contrast.

2. What's Working Well

A redesign should protect these assets, not replace them:

- **Authentic, vulnerable storytelling.** Andrew's and Maria's testimony pages (cancer, divorce, depression, single parenthood, healing) are the most persuasive content on the site. Very few competitors have anything like this.
- **Twelve substantive testimonials.** Named, specific, outcome-oriented — excellent social proof that is currently buried on a secondary page.
- **Clear offer architecture.** Three programs with plain-language descriptions, stated inclusions, and honest pricing (Free / \$400 / \$400). The free 30-minute session is a genuinely strong lead magnet.
- **Complete legal footprint.** Terms, Privacy, Refund, Accessibility statement, and a thoughtful ministry disclaimer that correctly distinguishes coaching from licensed therapy.
- **A workable visual identity.** The sage green / cream / black palette and mountain-and-river imagery give a calm, hopeful feel worth keeping. Real contact details (phone and email) are published.

3. Detailed Findings

Findings are grouped into eight categories. Severity reflects impact on the ministry's goals (being found, being trusted, and converting visitors into booked sessions or donations).

A. Search Visibility & SEO

#	Finding	Severity	Recommendation
1	Every page includes meta robots "noindex" — the site is invisible to Google, Bing, etc. This is a Wix setting ("hide from search engines") that is currently on.	Critical	Wix Dashboard → Settings → SEO: enable indexing. Then connect Google Search Console and submit the sitemap.
2	Site name is "New SAM 2026" in every page title, og:site_name, and social-share preview (e.g. "Home New SAM 2026").	Critical	Rename the site to "The Shepherd & Me"; write per-page titles, e.g. "Christian Life & Spiritual Coaching The Shepherd & Me."
3	No meta descriptions on any page; no og:image; sharing the site on Facebook/Instagram/text yields a blank, unbranded card.	High	Add 150–160 character descriptions per page and one branded social-share image site-wide.
4	No local signals. The ministry serves La Crescenta / Santa Clarita (Higher Vision Church is mentioned only in bios), yet no page mentions the service area.	High	Add location copy and create a free Google Business Profile — the fastest path to being found by nearby seekers.
5	Confusing URL slugs: Maria's story lives at /andrew-personal-story-1; the Accessibility page at /privacy-policy-1; the disclaimer at /privacy-	Medium	Rename slugs (/maria-story, /accessibility, /ministry-disclaimer) and let Wix create 301 redirects.

	policy-1-1.		
6	Heading structure misused: paragraph text is tagged as H2 on the homepage, empty headings exist, and the H1 contains invisible zero-width characters.	Medium	Retag text with correct heading levels; one H1 per page, H2 for sections.
7	Default Wix favicon (site shows the generic Wix icon in tabs).	Low	Upload the ministry's mark as favicon.

B. Trust & Credibility

#	Finding	Severity	Recommendation
1	The Terms of Use still contain the name of a different organization — “Harvest Ministries” — in the account-termination clause, and one copyright sentence is broken mid-thought (“...other copyright ally copy and print hard copy...”). The text appears to have been copied from another ministry's site.	High	Replace with terms written for The Shepherd & Me (template services or counsel), and proofread the full document.
2	The ministry's own domain is misspelled twice in legal pages, two different ways: “www.shpeherdandme.com” (Terms) and “www.sherpherdandme.com” (Privacy).	High	Correct both to www.shepherdandme.com .
3	Visible typos: “Minsitry Disclaimer” (footer link on every page), “Reund Policy” (page heading), “PRAYER INTECESSOR” (About page title for Maria).	High	Fix: Ministry, Refund, Intercessor. These appear on the site's most-seen surfaces.
4	Footer social icons on several pages link to facebook.com/wix and instagram.com/wix (template defaults) instead of the ministry's real accounts — which do exist and are linked correctly in the header.	High	Point all social icons to business.facebook.com/shepherdandme and instagram.com/theshepherdandme .
5	AI-generation artifacts are publicly visible: image alt text and filenames such as “ChatGPT Image Jul 1, 2026, 02_10_58 PM.png” and testimonial avatars named “ai-generated-IMAGE.jpg.”	Medium	Rename files before upload and write human alt text (“Andrew and Maria Segovia”). Screen readers currently announce the ChatGPT filenames.
6	“Powered and secured by Wix” appears in the footer.	Low	Removable on current Wix premium plans.

C. Navigation & Information Architecture

#	Finding	Severity	Recommendation
1	The menu shows different items on different pages: Home/Coaching/Get Started on the homepage;	High	One identical menu on every page: Home, Coaching, About,

	About/Testimonials/Get Involved on the About page; Home/Coaching/Get Involved on story pages; Donate and Contact appear only sometimes. A small arrow paginates through hidden items.		Testimonials, Get Involved, plus a visually distinct “Book a Free Session” button.
2	On the Donate page the footer menu renders on top of the header menu (overlapping text glitch).	Medium	Fix the overlapping strip in the Wix editor.
3	Legal pages print their headings below the body text (“PRIVACY POLICY” appears at the very bottom of the privacy page).	Low	Move page titles above content.
4	The About dropdown lists “Andrew Personal Story” and “Maria Personal Story” twice each.	Low	Remove duplicated submenu entries.

D. Design & Readability

#	Finding	Severity	Recommendation
1	Scroll-triggered fade animations leave core content almost unreadable — program titles, descriptions, and prices sit at low opacity (light gray on light gray), and in our testing sections sometimes remained half-faded after scrolling. This affects the exact copy that sells the coaching programs.	Critical	Remove or drastically shorten fade-ins; body copy should rest at full contrast (WCAG AA: 4.5:1).
2	The “Coaching Programs” homepage heading renders cut off past the left edge of the screen at standard desktop sizes.	High	Constrain heading to the content grid.
3	Large stretches of empty space: a full screen-height blank region mid-page on Coaching Services, and vast black voids in the footer with a stray photo of the couple placed low-left.	Medium	Tighten section spacing; design the footer as a compact, useful block (nav, contact, social, legal).
4	Typography is inconsistent: at least three typefaces; the “Coaching Programs” heading uses a different font and gray tone than every other heading; some headings are duplicated in gray behind sections (“PURPOSE” ghost text).	Medium	Adopt one display face + one text face with a fixed type scale.
5	Pricing presentation is fragmented: floating “Total” labels, a lone “\$400” far from its description, “Free” shown twice for the intro session.	Medium	Present each program as one card: name, description, inclusions, single price, one button.
6	Thin vertical template grid-lines are visible across hero images and sections.	Low	Remove the template strip borders.
7	The header bar is transparent over the homepage hero but flat gray on interior pages, reading as unstyled.	Low	Consistent header treatment site-wide.

8	Imagery issues: coaching cards use gardening stock (“Hands Holding Soil,” “Seedlings in Trays,” “Fresh Green Stalks,” “Gardening With Shovel”) left over from the template — while the homepage uses well-chosen spiritual imagery for the same programs. The testimonials background photo is stretched (1520×3377) and distorted. The Donate page background is a bleak photo of bare winter branches behind an invitation to give.	Medium	Reuse the ministry’s own imagery (praying hands, forest sunrays, hiker) consistently; replace the donate background with warm imagery.
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E. Content & Copy

#	Finding	Severity	Recommendation
1	Both “Enquire” (buttons) and “Inquire Now” (hero link) are used — mixed British/American spelling on the same page.	Low	Standardize on “Inquire,” or better, replace with an action label (“Book Free Session”).
2	The hero message order differs between desktop (“Heal Your Past / Hear God Clearly / Live on Purpose”) and mobile (“Hear God Clearly” first).	Low	Pick one order; it is the brand promise.
3	Twelve excellent testimonials are presented as unbroken walls of text with tiny AI-generated avatars; several exceed 300 words with no pull quotes; “Read more” links appear under already-expanded text.	Medium	Card layout with short pull-quote + expandable full text; feature the 3 strongest on the homepage.
4	The free 30-minute Spiritual Encounter session — the strongest conversion asset — is listed as just the first of three cards with no special prominence.	High	Make “Book a free 30-minute session” the site-wide primary call to action.
5	No FAQ. The ministry disclaimer already answers the most common objection (coaching vs. licensed therapy) but is buried at /privacy-policy-1-1.	Medium	Add a short FAQ on the coaching page (what to expect, coaching vs. counseling, how sessions run, refunds).

F. Conversion Paths

#	Finding	Severity	Recommendation
1	Six different call-to-action labels exist — Begin Now, Book Now, Enquire, Inquire Now, Get Started, Book a Discovery Call — and none leads to an actual booking step; most dead-end at a generic contact form.	High	One primary CTA everywhere with one destination: a scheduling page for the free session.
2	The homepage Donate button links to the Contact page, not the donation form.	Critical	Point it at /get-involved.
3	The coaching page’s closing “Book a Discovery	Critical	Link to scheduler or contact form.

	Call” button links back to the coaching page itself (a circular link — clicking it reloads the same page).		
4	No online scheduling. Every inquiry requires a form submission and a wait, losing motivated visitors.	High	Wix Bookings or Calendly embed for the free 30-minute session.
5	No email capture anywhere, although the Terms describe email subscriptions. Visitors not ready to book have no low-commitment next step.	Medium	Simple newsletter/devotional signup in the footer and after stories.
6	The Contact page shows no direct email or phone above the fold (they exist only in the footer); the Donate form offers only fixed \$10/\$20/\$30 with no custom amount visible, no statement of what gifts fund, and no tax-deductibility note.	Medium	Surface contact details on the contact page; add donation impact copy, custom amounts, and tax status if applicable.

G. Accessibility

#	Finding	Severity	Recommendation
1	Contrast failures from the fade/gray treatment on program copy, ghost headings, and pale labels — several elements fall well below WCAG AA 4.5:1.	High	Full-contrast body text; check with a contrast tool after theme edits.
2	Image alt text is machine filenames (“ChatGPT Image...”, “ai-generated-IMAGE.jpg”) — screen-reader users hear noise instead of descriptions.	Medium	Write descriptive alt text for every image.
3	The paginated arrow menu and per-page menu variations are hostile to keyboard and screen-reader navigation.	High	A single conventional menu resolves this together with the IA fix.
4	Broken heading hierarchy (see A6) also degrades screen-reader outlines. Positive: an Accessibility Statement page exists — ahead of most small sites.	Medium	Fix heading levels; keep the statement and link it from a corrected footer label.

H. Technical Health

#	Finding	Severity	Recommendation
1	The browser console logs 11 identical JavaScript errors on the homepage (“App not found for script”), suggesting a removed/misconfigured Wix app still being referenced.	Medium	Review installed apps in the Wix dashboard; remove orphaned references.
2	The homepage makes ~178 network requests on first load; the hero photo alone is served at 1520×1731. Heavy loads hurt mobile visitors and search ranking.	Medium	Compress/resize imagery; limit apps; Wix’s own image tools can serve smaller variants.

3	Mobile rendering is broadly acceptable, but the hero headline is cropped at 390px and the hero panel order flips (green box above headline).	Medium	Adjust mobile-specific layout in the Wix editor.
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4. Prioritized Roadmap

Phase 1 — This week (all inside Wix, no cost)

- Turn off “hide from search engines”; rename the site from “New SAM 2026” to “The Shepherd & Me”; add page titles, meta descriptions, a social-share image, and a favicon; submit the sitemap to Google Search Console.
- Fix all typos (Ministry, Refund, Intercessor, both domain misspellings) and replace the “Harvest Ministries” clause and broken sentence in the Terms.
- Repair links: homepage Donate → Get Involved; coaching “Book a Discovery Call” → contact/scheduler; standardize every CTA to one label.
- Replace the gardening stock photos with the ministry’s existing spiritual imagery; point footer social icons at the real Facebook/Instagram accounts.
- Remove the fade-to-invisible animations and fix the off-screen “Coaching Programs” heading.

Phase 2 — Next 2–4 weeks

- Unify the navigation menu across all pages; clean up URL slugs with redirects.
- Add online scheduling (Wix Bookings or Calendly) and promote the free 30-minute session as the site-wide primary call to action.
- Redesign testimonials as scannable cards with pull quotes; feature three on the homepage.
- Show email and phone on the contact page; add a short FAQ (coaching vs. counseling, what to expect).
- Rework the donation page: warmer imagery, impact copy, custom amounts, tax-deductibility note if 501(c)(3).

Phase 3 — Strategic (1–3 months)

- Local SEO: Google Business Profile, service-area copy (La Crescenta, Santa Clarita, greater Los Angeles), and Search Console monitoring.
- Email list: a simple devotional or resource download as a signup incentive; the Terms already anticipate email subscriptions.
- Analytics: GA4 with conversion events on bookings, form submissions, and donations.
- Longer term, consider the rebuilt architecture shown in the accompanying demo as the target design if the ministry outgrows the current template.

5. About the Accompanying Redesign Demo

Alongside this report we built a working, publishable demo (a single self-contained HTML file) that rebuilds the full site — Home, Coaching, About, both personal stories, Testimonials, Get Involved, and Contact — using the ministry’s own words, imagery, and palette. Nothing about the ministry’s voice was replaced; the demo simply presents the same material with:

- One consistent navigation bar and footer on every page, with a single primary action: “Book a Free Session.”
- The free 30-minute session promoted as the natural first step, with the paid programs presented as clear, readable cards.
- Testimonials as featured pull-quote cards (with the full library one click away) and Andrew & Maria’s stories given a clean long-form reading layout.
- Accessibility-compliant contrast, descriptive alt text, semantic headings, and a mobile-first responsive layout.
- SEO-ready titles and descriptions on every page of the demo, plus corrected footer links and legal-page labels.

The demo is a design proposal, not a production build: forms are visual mock-ups, and the booking button illustrates the intended flow. It can be opened in any browser, shared with stakeholders, or published to any static host as a preview of the proposed direction.

We would welcome the chance to walk through this review together and help implement whichever phase is most useful first.

— Spark Alliance · serviceteam@sparkallianceinc.com